

Google goggles

Another Google service, this one's available only for those with an Android phone for now

Whacking Wave

We introduced you to Wave last month. This month, we're telling you of options other than Wave

Signing off



Security has moved beyond software

Online security

Security on the internet, especially when it comes to online transactions, has always been a major concern. Passwords can be stolen, phished or simply lost and hence, experts have long been trying to create a better way for authenticating one's identity on the web. One of the ways in which security can be upped is by introducing another layer of security over and above the username and password. This is known as two-factor authentication (2FA). It has proven itself quite effective for averting unauthorised transactions. The way 2FA takes place is pretty

simple – a hardware token or a card sized device generates a code that users need to enter along with their passwords on web sites. Earlier netbanking web sites that had opted for 2FA security authentication, would provide these hardware devices to their customers.

VeriSign, a company otherwise best known for SSL certificates and its check sign, has brought 2FA to a new form factor – the mobile phone. Rajiv Chadha, VP, VeriSign India, gave us a demo of this format at a special briefing in Mumbai. The process is quite simple. Users have to register once and acquire a unique credential ID. This number is locked to a J2ME application that can be downloaded for free on any compatible phone. Further, this credential can be linked to a number of user ids on different sites that use VIP (VeriSign Identity Protection). The app generates a six-digit code that changes every 30 seconds. The credential is registered with a relying party web service - and every time you initiate a login session to your web service, in

This month we check out among other things Google's entry into real time search, and as a prelude to our security issue a look at innovative web security measures from VeriSign

addition to entering your easy to remember userid and password, you also enter the six-digit code from your credential as a second password. This service is also available via SMS.

Many web sites such as PayPal and Ebay have this as an optional layer of security. "In fact PayPal in the UK has already made this mandatory," says Chadha. So the next time you're logging in to even your favourite social networking site, don't be surprised if you find yourself reaching for your phone. Even if it's non-mandatory for now, users should probably opt for this service voluntarily. With this added layer of security, a hacker will not only have to steal your password, but physically reach into your pocket to steal your phone too – quite an unlikely situation. There are currently about 70 web sites where VIP is available. To get a full list head over to www.vipmobile.verisign.com/wheretouse.v. In India, several brokerage and banking web sites are already in talks with VeriSign to implement this soon.

Phantom of the new Opera

Opera has always been somewhat the preferred browser of the uber geek. It's the only browser to get 100 on the acid3 test, and for long had the reputation of being a stable browser, always on the cutting edge of innovation. Recently,

we came across a web rumour that the new build of the Opera browser would feature hardware acceleration.

Turns out, the alpha build for the new version (10.5) code named Evenes has been leaked. The browser is all about speed says a blog post from Opera. It might feature the Carakan Javascript engine, making it 250 per cent faster than the current build. In terms of UI improvements, it will feature a lot of elements we've seen in competing browsers such as Chrome, Safari and Firefox.

Opera is now expected to have a new skin featuring a merged tab bar – a Chrome rip off – the top of the screen won't have the title bar but tabs. Those annoying dialog boxes for saving passwords and other information will be integrated into the UI and will now appear discreetly just below the address bar. There is going to be a improved find feature. This was something that was rather annoying with Opera. In the existing build, you need to jump from one search term to another. In the new avatar it will follow the screen darkening and highlighting that Safari has. There is going to be better integration with Windows 7, meaning jumplists and task bar thumb nail tabs. Incognito browsing is being ported to opera too. Rounding up the changes is the new rendering engine – presto. Still, we couldn't find a mention of hardware acceleration. If it does happen the power if

DO
this

Phish or no phish

This fun resource from VeriSign lets you hone your skills when it comes to spotting a fake web page. It shows you two seemingly identical web pages and asks you to spot the phishing attempt. Whether you're able to spot the imposter or not, the web site will highlight crucial differences you should spot. Head over to www.phish-or-no-phish.com